

The Book of Romans

By Dn Yonnas · Scripture · Youth & Young Adults

Summary

St. Paul's letter to Rome read through Orthodox eyes: not a courtroom but a hospital. Sin is the sickness, Christ is the Medhanit (Healer), grace is the medicine, and the Church is where recovery happens. The lesson walks through the diagnosis (ch. 1–3), the medicine of grace (4–5), recovery in baptism and the Spirit (6–8), and the healthy life of the community (12–16).

Lesson Objectives

- Read Romans through the Orthodox 'hospital' framework of healing rather than only legal acquittal
- Explain faith and works as synergy — two sides of one coin
- Understand the Two Adams: death through the first, life through Christ the Second Adam

Key Bible Verses

Romans 3:23 — "all have sinned and fall short of the glory of God"

Romans 5:12–21 — the Two Adams

Romans 6:3–4 — buried with Christ in baptism into newness of life

Main Teaching Points

- Justification is healing: we were sick with sin and Christ makes us whole
- Paul levels the field — Jew and Gentile alike fall short and need the same Physician
- Grace (Tsega) is the life-giving power of God, received through faith
- Baptism is the beginning of recovery; the Spirit leads sanctification
- 'Works of the Law' (rituals like circumcision) are not the same as works of love
- St. John Chrysostom had Romans read to him twice a week; St. Cyril taught our organic union with Christ from it

Key Terms

- **Justification** — In the Orthodox reading: not only a legal status but the healing and restoration of our broken nature in Christ.
- **Medhanit** — Savior / Healer — Christ as the Great Physician who restores human nature.
- **Synergy** — Cooperation between God's grace and our free response — faith working through love.
- **Sanctification** — The lifelong recovery and growth in holiness that follows baptism, led by the Holy Spirit.

Discussion & Reflection

- How does seeing Romans as a hospital instead of a courtroom change how you read it?
- What is the difference between earning salvation and cooperating with grace?
- Where do you need the Physician's healing in your own life right now?